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Military Wargaming Solutions for Decision Assessment

A comparative review of TEWT-oriented training systems, tactical wargames and operational simulators - with emphasis on misinformation, delayed information and evidence-based assessment.

Decision in one sentence
Company Commander is the closest tactical TEWT + plan-versus-execution match; VBS is the clearest publicly documented TEWT training platform; Command Professional Edition is the strongest adjacent fit for communications and intelligence modelling. No reviewed product is publicly verified as a turnkey, validated test specifically for misinformation plus delayed information.

Scope

Six solution families are reviewed: Company Commander (including AI/Anywhere variants), Virtual Battlespace / VBS3, Steel Beasts, Command: Modern Operations / Command Professional Edition, JCATS, and Division Commander. Public product pages and official government training pages were prioritised. Country-use claims attributed to a vendor are identified as such; no attempt is made to infer proprietary internal technology stacks.

What this report does not claim

Military use does not automatically mean a system is a formal TEWT assessment tool. A model of intermittent communications or intelligence uncertainty is not the same as a controlled experimental feature that injects misinformation or delays messages and then validates a human decision-quality score. These distinctions are marked throughout.

Executive assessment

There is no single publicly documented off-the-shelf product in this review that demonstrably does all four things together: (1) formal TEWT-style exercise delivery, (2) controlled misinformation injection, (3) controlled information-delay manipulation, and (4) validated scoring of human decision quality. Select by primary training objective, then verify exact assessment mechanics with the vendor or institution.

Best starting choices

Closest tactical fit: Company Commander / Company Commander AI, because it combines tactical PME, Before Action Report (BAR), After Action Report (AAR), scenario authoring, and an AI/research edition with an external API and headless simulation. It does not publicly confirm built-in misinformation/delay experiments. [1] [2] [3]

Best explicit TEWT precedent: VBS/VBS3 in the U.S. Army Games for Training programme, whose public description explicitly says it supports TEWT for higher-echelon units and staffs. [5]

Best adjacent information / comms modelling: Command Professional Edition (CPE), which documents COMINT, intermittent/non-real-time communications, sensor-fusion capability levels and professional analysis interfaces. These are simulation capabilities, not proof of a purpose-built human misinformation test. [9]

At-a-glance comparison

Solution	Primary specialty	TEWT fit	Misinformation / delay evidence	Access
Company Commander / AI	Tactical PME; BAR/AAR; scenario & AI experimentation	High (vendor-defined tactical TEWT use)	Custom scenarios and data capture; dedicated misinformation/delay feature not verified	Institutional / licensed; some variants cross-platform
VBS / VBS3	Immersive virtual simulation, rehearsal, scenario authoring	High (U.S. Army GFT explicitly lists TEWT)	Scenario scripting/AAR; controlled info-delay/deception assessment not verified	Professional / government-oriented access
Steel Beasts Pro	Armoured crew, platoon/formation tactics, AAR	Medium (tactical training, not primarily TEWT assessment)	No dedicated misinformation/delay test publicly documented	Consumer Personal Edition; separate professional licence
CMO / CPE	Cross-domain operational wargaming, analysis, comms/sensors	Low-to-medium for ground TEWT; higher operational staff fit	CPE models intermittent/non-real-time comms & intelligence-related systems; no validated human test confirmed	CMO consumer purchase; CPE professional licence
JCATS	Entity-level constructive simulation; staff/joint training	Medium (staff simulation; TEWT designation not found on cited page)	High-resolution entities and exercise feeds; dedicated misinformation/delay test not verified	Military/institutional system
Division Commander	Division/corps decisions; intelligence, sustainment, C2	Low for company-level TEWT; high for operational command education	Intelligence collection/identification affects what is known; explicit misinformation/delay test not confirmed	PME/institutional; verify current package and feature status

Interpretation: “High” describes alignment with the stated training format based on public documentation; it does not mean a product’s assessment validity has been independently established. Claims about product use and capabilities can be vendor-reported. Sources: Company Commander [1]; U.S. Army GFT [5]; Steel Beasts [6] [7]; CPE [9]; JCATS [10]; Division Commander [11].

1. Company Commander (plus AI / Anywhere editions)

Most directly aligned to tactical decision education and BAR/AAR

Tactical PME • Scenario authoring • Plan-versus-execution • Research API in AI edition

Specialty and why it matters

HexWar describes Company Commander as a tactical professional military education wargame covering small-unit combat from WWII to near-future multi-domain operations. The company states it is in institutional use with the U.S. Army and U.S. Marine Corps. These usage statements are vendor-reported. The game is designed for classroom, individual learning, syndicate, and tournament formats. [1]

Core capabilities

• Scenario toolkit and pre-built scenarios; force builder and configurable force structures. • Before Action Report (BAR): participants record intended plan before the game. • After Action Report (AAR): compares decisions/actions and outcomes; vendor describes more than 100,000 data points per scenario. • AI edition: vendor describes adaptive AI, an external WebSocket API, Python/PyTorch integration, and headless batch simulation. [1] [2] [3]

Technology stack: what is actually known

The Company Commander Anywhere page states that source code is C++ and available for amendment under licence. The AI edition describes an external WebSocket interface with Python/PyTorch integration and headless simulation. HexWar Management System describes user/team profiles, central data storage, and air-gapped deployment options. These facts do not disclose a complete backend stack, database engine, hosting design, or model internals. [12] [2] [4]

Similarity to your intended system

Strongest fit for: tactical TEWT-style learning, baseline plans, replay/debrief, and instrumentation-oriented research. The AI edition is the most promising integration candidate if you need repeatable runs and external analytics. Unverified gap: public documentation does not confirm a ready-made feature to randomise misleading reports, delay specific intelligence inputs, measure the effect as a validated construct, or generate a psychometrically validated score. The analytics tool page labels BAR/AAR as beta; confirm current release status, API access, event schema, and licensing with HexWar. [2] [3]

Best use in the project

Use it as the benchmark platform for tactical scenario and plan-versus-execution comparison. Before committing, run a vendor proof-of-concept for: controlled message timing, controlled source/reliability labels, event-level timestamps, repeatable scenario seeds, and data export. Do not assume these are standard features.

2. Virtual Battlespace (VBS / VBS3)

Best documented immersive TEWT delivery example

3D virtual terrain • Scenario authoring • After-action review • Government training programme

Specialty and real-world training use

The U.S. Army's Games for Training (GFT) public page states that the programme uses Virtual Battlespace software, including VBS3, and supports training from individual soldiers through company-size units. It explicitly states that GFT trains higher-echelon units and staffs with Tactical Exercises Without Troops (TEWT). It describes a suite of gaming laptops with VBS, scenario-development tools, geo-specific/geo-typical terrain, mission rehearsal and AAR. [5]

Technology stack: what is actually known

The simulation platform and its internal engine/language/database stack are proprietary and not described in the cited public GFT page. Publicly evidenced features include virtual 3D environments, scenario-development tools, terrain libraries and after-action review. GFT also lists integration dependencies such as One World Terrain and the Common Synthetic Environment. Do not treat these integrations as a disclosure of VBS's internal stack. [5]

Similarity to your intended system

Strongest fit for: visually rich scenarios, instructor-led exercise control, terrain-context, and TEWT-compatible training workflow. Unverified gap: the cited sources do not establish a built-in, controlled misinformation/delayed-intelligence experiment with a validated decision-quality score. Those conditions may require instructor scripting, integration or a separate assessment layer.

3. Steel Beasts Professional / Personal Edition

Best for armoured crew and small-formation tactical simulation

Vehicle-centric • Tactical/formation training • Professional AAR • Consumer version exists

Specialty and use

eSim Games describes Steel Beasts Professional as a PC-based virtual simulation for armoured vehicle crews, gunnery, crew procedures, platoon battle drills, formation-level tactical education and constructive simulation. Its public page names land forces in Australia, Austria, Denmark, Finland, Spain, Sweden and the Netherlands among its primary customers; this is a vendor statement. [7]

Edition distinction

The developer explicitly separates the consumer Steel Beasts product from Steel Beasts Professional. The Professional version is intended for soldiers in a networked simulation lab under an operator/controller; it adds instructor mode, advanced AAR, saved AAR files, map import/creation and larger mission areas. The consumer version is intended for entertainment and has client limitations. [6]

Technology stack: what is actually known

eSim describes the product as a Windows-platform simulation built using consumer gaming technology and techniques. The detailed engine, codebase internals, database and service architecture are not publicly specified in the reviewed pages. [7]

Similarity to your intended system

Strongest fit for: tactical decisions where terrain, visibility, platform handling, crew coordination and formation actions matter, with instructor-controlled exercise and AAR in the professional edition. Weak fit for a pure decision test: the product is vehicle/combined-arms centred; public documentation does not establish configurable deception/delay experiments or psychometric decision scoring.

4. Command: Modern Operations (CMO) / Command Professional Edition (CPE)

Best adjacent option for operational intelligence, communications and systems analysis

Air/naval and cross-domain • Sensor/comms modelling • Analysis APIs in pro edition • Commercial game available

Specialty and use

CMO is a commercially available, real-time-pausable operational wargame with an editor and broad air, sea, space and limited ground-operation coverage. CPE is its professional-oriented superset for military, government, commercial and academic uses. The CPE vendor reports deployments across 25+ nations and 150+ organisations; treat those numbers as vendor-reported. [8] [9]

Decision-relevant capabilities

CPE lists COMINT, intermittent/non-real-time communications, explicit communication networks, data/sensor-fusion capability levels and mission-planning integrations. It also advertises professional analysis, a web API, Lua TCP/IP connectivity in some editions, and headless/Monte Carlo analysis capabilities. These may help represent uncertainty and communication friction. [9]

Technology stack: what is actually known

The official FAQ describes CMO’s simulation engine as multithreaded and CPU-intensive. CPE publishes API and licensing capabilities, but its internal language, engine implementation, database schema and hosting stack are not fully disclosed in the cited product materials. Do not infer them from scripting/API support. [14] [9]

Similarity to your intended system

Strongest fit for: operational-level information flow, sensor fusion, intermittent communications, and repeatable analysis. Gap: communications modelling is not automatically a controlled human-subject delayed-information experiment; public material does not verify a built-in false-report injection protocol or standard decision-quality instrument. It is less directly TEWT/company-tactical than Company Commander or VBS.

5. JCATS (Joint Conflict and Tactical Simulation)

Entity-level constructive simulation for staff and joint training

Constructive simulation • Entity-level resolution • Staff training • Military environment

Specialty and use

The U.S. Marine Corps training command describes JCATS as an entity-level constructive simulation capable of modelling units down to individuals. It is used at Twentynine Palms, California, and can provide greater fidelity for some training applications, including scenarios involving unmanned aerial systems. [10]

Training strengths

JCATS supports staff exercises and a common operating picture distributed across training locations. The official page lists training applications spanning offensive/defensive operations, fire support, logistics, air/naval activity and opposing forces. This is evidence of a broad training system, not a dedicated decision-psychology product. [10]

Technology stack and access

JCATS is a proprietary professional system. The cited source does not disclose its programming language, database or internal architecture. It references VRSG/NVESD for certain UAS feeds; these are associated components, not JCATS's core stack. No public retail edition is described.

Similarity to your intended system

Best fit: entity-level, staff and distributed exercises. Gap: no cited public evidence of controlled misinformation/delay experiments or a validated individual decision score. Institutional access needs direct confirmation.

6. Division Commander (HexWar)

Operational command decisions: intelligence collection, C2, logistics and sustainment

Division-to-corps level • Intelligence affects visibility • Sustainment consequences • PME analytics direction

Specialty and mechanics

HexWar describes Division Commander as a division-to-corps PME wargame about operational outcomes. Its page says intelligence collection affects what commanders know about enemy locations, movement, composition and strength, and that commanders choose where to invest in intelligence. It also models C2 capacity, posture, supply, fatigue and asset allocation. [11]

Assessment and status caveat

The page describes a connection to the HexWar Management System and AAR analytics layer, while additional analytics, scenario/order-of-battle editing and multiplayer capability appear in a stated development roadmap. Because roadmaps and availability can change, confirm current product access and which analysis features are released versus planned before treating them as existing capabilities. [11] [4]

Technology stack

The public page does not disclose the implementation language, engine, database or hosting internals. Verify the current API and event schema with the vendor. [11] [4]

Similarity to your intended system

Best fit: operational judgement shaped by intelligence collection, C2, logistics and sustained operations. Gap: division/corps rather than company-level TEWT; deliberate misinformation and delay experiments are not confirmed.

Technology-stack reality check

The user request includes “tech stack if known.” For military training products, the commercial/API-facing surface is often documented while the simulation engine internals are proprietary. This table records only technology claims supported by the product pages reviewed; “not public” means not disclosed by the cited sources, not that a capability does not exist.

Solution	Publicly documented technical details	Not disclosed / needs vendor confirmation
Company Commander / AI	Company Commander Anywhere states C++ source available for amendment under licence. AI edition documents external WebSocket API; Python/PyTorch integration; headless batch runs. HMS describes central user/team data and air-gapped deployment option. [12] [2] [4]	Full backend framework, database vendor/schema, cloud provider, event-log format, release-specific API documentation, exact information-injection controls.
VBS / VBS3	VBS simulation; scenario development; virtual terrain; AAR; Army GFT deployment includes gaming laptops and integration dependencies. [5]	Underlying language, engine internals, database, service layer, exact scenario scripting interfaces and data-export schema.
Steel Beasts Professional	Windows PC-based simulation, consumer gaming technology/techniques, networked instructor/operator mode, advanced AAR and map import in the Professional edition. [6] [7]	Internal engine/language, database, APIs, structured event export beyond documented AAR formats.
CMO / CPE	Multithreaded CPU-intensive simulation (CMO FAQ); CPE APIs and Lua TCP/IP connectivity in specified pro editions; headless/Monte Carlo analysis and COMINT/intermittent non-real-time communications. [9] [14]	Detailed implementation language, database, service runtime, underlying sensor/comms model source code and exact per-licence interfaces.
JCATS	Entity-level constructive simulation; official page references integrations for specific visual/UAS feeds. [10]	Implementation stack, database, custom scripting/API and access rights to detailed event data.
Division Commander	HexWar describes connection to HMS and AAR analytics; scenario mechanics include intelligence collection, C2, resource/supply/fatigue models. [11] [4]	Internal engine/language/database, current API schema, release status of roadmap analytics and ability to time-stamp/extract every decision.

Do not build on guessed stacks

A product having a Python API does not mean its core engine is Python. A product having a web API does not reveal its backend framework. AAR charts do not necessarily mean that raw event-level logs are exportable. For a research prototype, request the API documentation, event schema, data rights, scenario-control capability, and a sample anonymised run log before selecting a platform.

Which solution is most similar to your target?

Target requirement: a training application focused on evaluating human decision-making in TEWT-style scenarios when reports may be misleading, information arrives late, and the participant has to act with uncertainty. The matrix grades public evidence for fit, not product quality.

Requirement	Company Commander AI	VBS / VBS3	Steel Beasts Pro	CMO / CPE	JCATS	Division Commander
Tactical TEWT alignment	High public alignment	High public alignment	Partial / adjacent capability	Partial / adjacent capability	Partial / adjacent capability	Not publicly verified
Plan vs execution assessment	High public alignment	Partial / adjacent capability	Partial / adjacent capability	Partial / adjacent capability	Not publicly verified	Partial / adjacent capability
Scenario authoring / control	High public alignment	High public alignment	High public alignment	High public alignment	Partial / adjacent capability	Partial / adjacent capability
Information / comms modelling	Partial / adjacent capability	Partial / adjacent capability	Not publicly verified	High public alignment	Partial / adjacent capability	High public alignment
Explicit controlled misinformation	Not publicly verified	Not publicly verified	Not publicly verified	Not publicly verified	Not publicly verified	Not publicly verified
Explicit information-delay experiment	Not publicly verified	Not publicly verified	Not publicly verified	Partial / adjacent capability	Not publicly verified	Partial / adjacent capability
Event-level analytic / AI integration	High public alignment	Partial / adjacent capability	Partial / adjacent capability	High public alignment	Not publicly verified	Partial / adjacent capability
Ordinary civilian play access	Partial / adjacent capability	Not publicly verified	High public alignment	High public alignment	Not publicly verified	Not publicly verified

Legend: high alignment = product page explicitly describes adjacent core function; partial = related mechanics exist but do not prove full fit; not publicly verified = reviewed public sources do not establish the specific capability. The misinformation row is intentionally conservative: none of the reviewed pages publicly verifies a dedicated feature designed for controlled misinformation experiments. Source base: [1], [2], [3], [5], [6], [7], [9], [10], [11].

Recommendation by objective

If the priority is…	Start with…	Reason
Tactical TEWT, written intent, debrief	Company Commander / Company Commander AI	Closest combination of tactical PME, BAR/AAR, scenario tools and research-oriented AI interfaces. Confirm exact experimental controls.
Immersive environment and official TEWT precedent	VBS / VBS3	U.S. Army GFT explicitly describes TEWT support; best reference for a virtual-terrain instructor-led workflow.
Operational comms, sensor/intelligence uncertainty	Command Professional Edition	Most explicit public descriptions of intermittent/non-real-time communications, COMINT, sensor fusion and analytical interfaces.
Armoured crew and formation execution	Steel Beasts Professional	Built for vehicle crew, battle drills and formation-level tactics with operator controls and AAR.
Division/corps operational judgement	Division Commander	Explicit intelligence collection and identification decisions, C2, sustainment and campaign consequences.

A practical blueprint for your exact assessment goal

If no off-the-shelf product exposes all required test conditions, build a controlled assessment layer around a suitable simulation platform. This is a high-level training/research architecture, not a claim that any vendor already provides these modules.

1. Scenario and ground truth

Fixed scenario, decision points, authoritative event timeline, versioned conditions.

↓ condition scheduler: baseline / delayed input / conflicting input / combined condition

2. Information delivery layer

Controls which reports are shown, their arrival time, provenance labels and later corrections. Records exactly what the participant saw and when.

↓

3. Simulation + trainee interface

The participant reviews the situation, records a plan, makes decisions, requests information where supported, and submits actions.

↓ event timestamps and decision records

4. Event log and assessment engine

Captures ground truth, available evidence, receipt times, decision timestamps, confidence, changes of mind, and outcomes. Uses pre-defined scoring rules.

↓

5. AAR and evaluator dashboard

Compares plan with actions; shows decision timeline, information available at each point, errors, updates, confidence calibration and rubric scores.

Recommended experiment design

Condition	What changes	Keep constant
Baseline	All required information arrives normally and is accurate.	Scenario, initial forces, objective, scoring rubric.
Delayed information	Predefined information arrives later than its baseline time.	Content validity and overall scenario difficulty; log the actual arrival time.
Conflicting / misleading information	A controlled source provides an inaccurate or contradictory report; later truth is recorded.	Scenario and decision opportunity; ethically debrief participants where applicable.
Combined condition	Predefined delay plus conflicting information.	Randomise condition assignment and keep scoring blinded where practical.

Possible outcome measures: decision quality against a pre-registered rubric; time to first decision; accuracy against ground truth; confidence calibration; speed and appropriateness of revision after correction; consistency between written plan and actions; and performance degradation/recovery across conditions. These are design suggestions, not features claimed for any of the products.

Procurement / proof-of-concept checklist

Before selecting a platform, ask for a short demonstration using a neutral test scenario that exercises the actual research requirements. A feature list is not enough: request an exported run log and evidence that the condition can be repeated.

Scenario manipulation

Can an instructor create and version scenarios without vendor engineering? Can scenario seeds/conditions be replayed?

Information timing

Can a message/report be deliberately held and released at specified times? Are delivery and read times separately timestamped?

Source accuracy and misinformation

Can the scenario distinguish correct, incomplete, stale, conflicting, and deliberately inaccurate reports? Can the truth state be logged separately from what the participant sees?

Decision capture

Can the system record decisions, plan changes, rationale, confidence, information requests, and the exact evidence available at decision time?

Event data and access

Is raw event-level data exportable? What format, API, licensing, retention, and data-protection constraints apply? Is research use permitted?

Validity

What rubric or validated instruments are available? Can the score be audited and its inter-rater reliability assessed? Do not treat win/loss alone as a measure of decision quality.

Repeatability and scale

Can conditions be randomized, repeated, and run with multiple participants? Can experimenters separate scenario difficulty from information condition?

Deployment and controls

Can it run in the required network environment? What instructor controls, audit logs, role permissions and approval controls are available?

Final selection recommendation

Run a proof-of-concept with Company Commander AI first if tactical TEWT-style decision assessment and fine-grained analytics are the main goals. In parallel, evaluate VBS/VBS3 if an immersive virtual-terrain exercise is central. Examine Command Professional Edition if communication latency, sensor fusion and operational information flows are the main experimental variables. None should be awarded as meeting all requirements until delayed-information and misinformation controls, event-level data export, and scoring validity have been demonstrated.

Confidence and limitations

This review relies on publicly accessible product/vendor and military training pages accessed on 14 October 2026. Vendor feature descriptions and customer-use claims are not independent efficacy evaluations. Internal technology stacks not disclosed in those sources are marked as not public. Licensing, availability, beta labels and roadmap items may change; confirm directly with providers before budgeting or designing a study.

Sources and further reading

The report prioritises official vendor product pages and official military/government pages. Links below are clickable. Product-specific capabilities are attributed to the source that describes them; vendor claims are not presented as independent validation.

[1] Company Commander – product overview (HexWar)
https://pme.hexwar.com/project/company-commander/

[2] Company Commander AI – API, headless simulation, adaptive AI (HexWar)
https://pme.hexwar.com/project/company-commander-ai/

[3] Analytical Reporting Tools – BAR/AAR (HexWar)
https://pme.hexwar.com/project/analytical-reporting-tools/

[4] HexWar Management System (HexWar)
https://pme.hexwar.com/project/hexwar-management-system/

[5] Games for Training – U.S. Army CPE ST3
https://www.cpest3.army.mil/Project-Offices/PM-SIM/PdD-NGC/GFT/

[6] Steel Beasts version differences – eSim Games
https://www.esimgames.com/version-differences/

[7] About eSim Games / Steel Beasts Professional
https://www.esimgames.com/about/

[8] Command: Modern Operations – product page (Matrix Games)
https://www.matrixgames.com/game/command-modern-operations

[9] Command Professional Edition – capabilities and licensing (Matrix Pro Sims)
https://command.matrixgames.com/?page_id=3822

[10] JCATS – Marine Air Ground Task Force Training Command
https://www.29palms.marines.mil/Training/magtftcsims/jcats/

[11] Division Commander – product overview (HexWar)
https://pme.hexwar.com/project/division-commander/

[12] Company Commander Anywhere – platform and feature details (HexWar)
https://pme.hexwar.com/project/company-commander-anywhere/

[13] Company Commander AI – vendor-described technical features (HexWar)
https://pme.hexwar.com/project/company-commander-ai/

[14] Command FAQ and system requirements (Matrix Games)
https://command.matrixgames.com/?page_id=2920

Scope note

Platforms included: Company Commander (standard / Anywhere / AI), Virtual Battlespace / VBS3, Steel Beasts Professional and Personal Edition, Command: Modern Operations and Command Professional Edition, JCATS, and Division Commander. Products adjacent to the list above may exist; “all” here means all solution families explicitly discussed in the conversation and their directly related editions.